

Unit-II

Understanding Harmony in the Human Being

We have seen that our fundamental motivation, our basic want- is that of continuous happiness and prosperity. We have also seen that the fulfillment of this want depends upon our understanding of the reality or harmony at every level of our existence.

We have also seen that we can understand this harmony through self-exploration. As human beings, our living extends from the Self to the entire existence. The four levels of our living are-

- *Living in myself/ Harmony with self*
- *Living in family/ Harmony with family*
- *Living in society/ Harmony with society*
- *Living in/ Harmony with natural existence.*

In this unit-II we will understand the human being as the co-existence of the Self (or I) and the Body.

1. Understanding the human being as the co-existence of Self (I) and Body

Human being is more than just the body: What do we visualize when we refer to someone as a human being? There is the familiar shape and structure of a human body that is immediately apparent to us and we imagine someone with similar human body-like features. But in addition to the body, we are also aware of the “**alive-ness**” of the person- the entity that keeps the body “alive” and makes it operate in various ways.

We perceive this “alive-ness” (Existence) in the activities demonstrated by the person like their seeing, talking, walking, eating, etc., On a deeper examination of the “alive-ness”, we sense the activities of the person- the person’s feelings, thinking, believing, etc., It is impossible to imagine a human being- a person that is alive- without these two aspects namely the Body and the “alive-ness”. This “alive-ness” is called “**Jivana**” (Life). Thus a human being is co-existence of the Body and “Jivana”.

This Jivana refers to itself as “I” (Self). Thus, we say – ‘I am so and so’ or ‘I feel tired’ or ‘I am happy’. This “I” or “Self” is also called “consciousness”. Each one of us can see that he/she has an awareness of “I” (Jivana) and an awareness of the body.

We are busy through the day performing different activities such as brushing our teeth, talking, studying, playing, etc., we consciously choose, decide and perform an activity with the knowledge that it is “I” who is performing these activities.

It is not the body that chooses, decides and performs these activities, without our consent or participation. **For example:** We don’t say my legs started walking by themselves! We say, “I decided to walk” i.e., the decision to walk is taken by “I” and not by the legs!

Similarly, we feel pleasure, pain, happiness and sadness. We all have experienced these feelings in ourselves. Sometimes when we meet someone we are thrilled and excited to be with that person. It is the body that feels the happiness of meeting someone or do I feel happy? The entity that experiences such feelings is 'I'.

So, the human being is co-existence of both these entities- the Self ('I') and the Body. In order to understand the implications of this co-existence, it will first be necessary to focus attention on the distinct characteristics of the Self and the Body. Needless to emphasize that the terms 'Self' or 'I' or 'Jivana' are referring to the same entity on which special attention will be focused.

2. Human being as a combination of the sentient 'I' and material body

Human beings are a complex combination of the sentiment 'I' which relates to all the feelings and the material 'body' which refers to all the physical facilities available to them. Often there is a clash between the needs of the body and the feelings. This may manifest itself in many ways.

For Example: The state of depression or sadness. In this state the body needs food and nourishment but the feelings over-ride the situation. Both these aspects of feelings and body needs and requirements form an essential part of 'what we are'. This **co-existence must be harmonious**.

Human needs: According to the theory of "Hierarchy of needs" given by Abraham Maslow:

- a) **Physiological needs:** For the most part, physiological needs are obvious– **they are the literal requirement for human survival**. If these requirements are not met (with the expectation of clothing, and shelter) the human body simply cannot continue to function.

Physiological needs includes: Breathing, Food, Clothing, Mental satisfaction, Water, Shelter, Sound sleep. Air, water and food are **metabolic requirements** for survival in all animals, including humans. Clothing and shelter provide necessary protection from the elements.

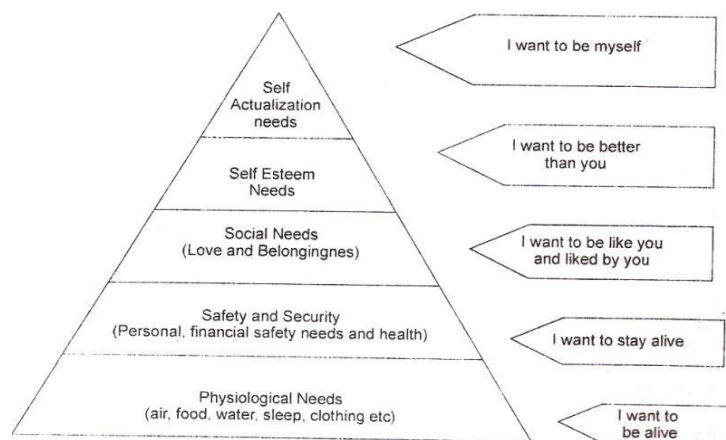


Fig. 2.2. Abraham Maslow's Hierarchy of needs with its interpretation

- b) **Safety needs:** With their physical needs relatively satisfied, the individual's safety needs take precedence and dominate behavior.

In the world of work, these safety needs manifest themselves in such things as **a preference for job security, grievance procedures for protecting the individual from unilateral authority, saving accounts, insurance policies, accommodations, etc.,**

Safety and security needs includes:

- Personal security
- Financial security
- Health and wellbeing
- Safety net against accidents/illness and their adverse impacts

- c) **Social needs:** Humans need to feel a sense of belonging and acceptance, whether it comes from a large social group, such as clubs, office culture, religious groups, professional organizations, sports teams, gangs or small social connections (family members, intimate partners, mentors, close colleagues, confidants).

They need to love and be loved by others. **In the absence of these elements, many people become susceptible to loneliness, social anxiety, and clinical depression.**

- d) **Self esteem:** All humans have a need to be respected and to have self esteem and self-respect. **Also known as the belonging need, esteem presents the normal human desire to be accepted and valued by others.** Imbalance at this level can result in low self-esteem or an inferiority complex. People with low self-esteem need respect from others.

3. Understanding Myself as the co-existence of self ('I') and 'Body'

Suvidha (convenience): It implies that it is looking for physical comforts and all the sources of attaining such comforts. When our body gets used to a certain level of comfort then we will only feel comfortable at that level.

For Example: Comfort in fan, cooler or air conditioner. Different people have a different perception of Suvidha and will seek a corresponding level of Suvidha according to their perceptions.

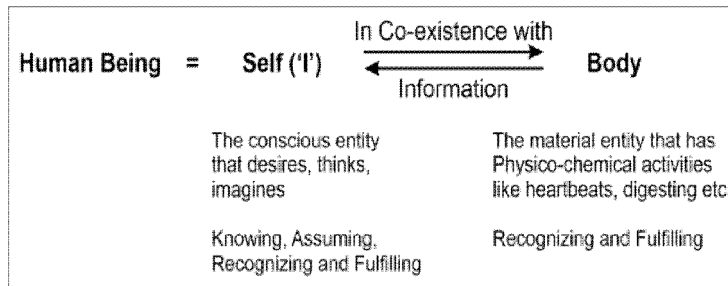
Happiness: The beauty of happiness is that **it is a holistic and all encompassing state of the mind that creates inner harmony.**

By nature man is fond of comfort and happiness. So, he goes on making desires and ambitions one after the other to enjoy more in life. To lead a comfortable life he also accumulates many facilities, so that his life may become full of comfort and happiness. Happiness depends upon our thinking, so many times we are surrounded by materialistic possessions but we feel unsatisfied.

People think that their happiness depends upon **Suvidha** (facilities) but is it not so; **happiness depends upon our thinking or our mental satisfaction.**

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Here is a proposal:



The human being is co-existence of 'I' and the Body, and there is exchange of information between the two. We can make this distinction between the Self and the Body in three ways in terms of **needs**, **activities** and the **types** of these two entities, as shown in the table follows:

			I	Body
Needs	Needs are...	→	Trust, Respect...	Food, Clothing...
		→	Happiness (sukh)	Physical Facilities (suvidhā)
	In Time, needs are...	→	Continuous	Temporary
	In Quantity, needs are...	→	Qualitative (no quantity)	Quantitative (limited in quantity)
	Needs are fulfilled by...	→	Right understanding and right feelings	Food, clothing, etc
Activities	Activities are...	→	Desiring, Thinking, etc	Breathing, heart-beat, etc
		→	Knowing, Assuming, Recognizing, Fulfilling	Recognizing, Fulfilling
Type	It is of type...	→	Conscious (non-material)	Physico-Chemical (material)

4. Understanding needs of the self and needs of the body

In the process of identifying the distinct characteristics of the self and the body, we will first focus towards their distinct needs:

1. Needs are

- The needs of the body like food for nourishment; clothes for protection and instruments to ensure right utilization can be categorized 'physical facilities' (Suvidha) whereas the need of 'I' is essentially to live in a state of continuous happiness.
- The **needs of the body are physical in nature**, whereas the **needs of the self ('I') are not physical in nature** - like trust, respect, happiness etc.,

2. In time, needs are...

- For example:** We need warm clothes during winter and lighter clothes during summer. We tend to change our clothing based on weather, i.e., the need for clothing for the body is **temporary** in nature.

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Similarly, If we talk about food, clothing, shelter, car or bike, these are needed only for some amount of time, or we can say that the need for physical facilities of the body is **temporary** in time- it is not continuous.

So, the **needs of the Body are temporary in time**. Summarizing the points we have made so far...

- The need of the **Body** is food, clothing, shelter or **physical facilities** and these are **temporary in time**.
- The need of '**I**' is happiness, trust, respect, etc., it is **not physical** in nature and it is **continuous in time**.

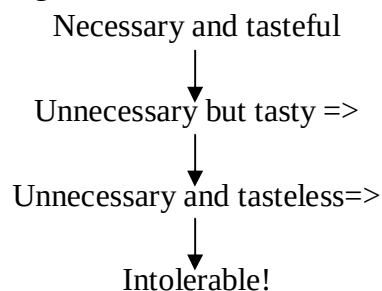
3. In Quality, needs are.....

a) For the Body: Quantitative

The needs of the body are quantitative! You can quantify your requirements for food, clothes, books, shoes, rooms, bikes, etc., The number may be large or small. But they are limited in quantity. **Physical facilities are needed for the body in a limited quantity**.

For example: You may need 4 chapattis per day, while your friend may need 10. I may need a bicycle to travel, your friend may need bike/ car. But the number of bicycles or cars that we are going to use is going to be limited again.

We can thus conclude that **physical facilities are needed for the Body in a limited quantity**. When we try and exceed these limits, it becomes trouble for us after some time. When we try to perpetuate physical facilities, the following pattern results. With time it successively changes from:



b) For the Self (I): Qualitative

On the other hand, the needs of Self (I) are qualitative, not quantitative. We cannot talk of 1kg of respect, half a meter of love or 2litres of affection! It even sounds simply ridiculous!

Happiness is qualitative. Either we are feeling happy or we are not. Also if a feeling is not naturally acceptable; we do not want it even for a single moment. If acceptable, we want it continuously.

4. Needs are fulfilled by....

The need of the self ('I'), for happiness is ensured by right understanding and right feelings, while the need of the body, for physical facilities (Suvidha), is ensured by appropriate physico-chemical things.

Let's take an example: Say, you are sitting in an AC room on a big comfortable sofa with a person for whom you have feeling of opposition. Here, the Body is so comfort, but how do **you** feel? – Happy or unhappy? You will be unhappy. There are enough physical facilities here, but not the right feeling in 'I'. Hence happiness is not ensured.

You might be sitting in a nice comfortable car, but if you are worried about something, you are still unhappy- although your body is fully fine and comfortable. This is an easy thing for each one of us to verify- all we need to do is start paying attentions to it!

Thus we can conclude:

- The need of the Self (I) for happiness is fulfilled by **right understanding and right feelings**, while the need of the Body is fulfilled by **physical facilities**.
- The need of the Self (I) is **qualitative and continuous** in nature, while the need of the Body is **quantitative and temporary** in nature.

5. Understanding the Body as an instrument of 'I' (I being the doer, seer and enjoyer)

With the previous discussion, we can now make a few more observations about I and Body. Let us explore the following proposals:

	I	Body
1	I am	My body is
2	I want to live	Body is used as an instrument (of 'I')
3	I want to live in continuous happiness	For nurture of body -----food For protection of body-----clothing, shelter, etc., For right utilization of body----instruments/ equipments etc., are needed as physical facilities
4	To understand and to live in harmony at all 4 levels is the program for my continuous happiness	Production, protection and right utilization of physical facilities is just a part of my program
5	I am the seer, doer and enjoyer	Body is an instrument

Read the following carefully and see if you can relate to what has been written. Read it twice or thrice until you are able to identify with what has been written!

1. I *am*. I exist. The body is.
 - I am the one that 'knows' that I exist. I am a conscious entity.
 - The “Body” doesn’t know. It is a material entity.
The awareness of being, of being alive, is in *me*, in 'I'.
2. “I” want to live. The “Body” is my instrument.
 - “I” and my “Body” co-exist with each other.
 - “I” am the one who takes decisions and the “Body” acts accordingly.

We all want to live. I want to live. I am the one that wants to live. The Body is my instrument. Not only am 'I' co-existence with the Body, but the Body also works like my instrument.

For example: When eating, we can see that it involves both you as well as your body. You decide to eat and pass the information to body. Thus, the food is picked, chewed and then swallowed.

Note that it is the self ('I') that chooses to eat and makes a choice of what to eat and how to eat. All this is taking place in 'I' and it is being done by you. The body is used as an instrument in the process of eating.

3. It's not just that I want to live. Just surviving alone is not enough for me. “I” want to live in Continuous Happiness. It is not the body that needs happiness, the Body needs Physical Facilities.
 - For the “I” to enjoy the feelings of Strength and Health, my body needs food.
 - To get the feeling of protection, my body needs clothing and shelter.
 - To utilize my Body (Right Utilization of the body), I need various instruments, equipments etc. With the help of these, my body can make me feel happy.
 - a) Listing all the needy of the Body, we can see that for the nurture of the body needs food, clothing and shelter are needed for protection.
 - b) We do not just need food, clothing and shelter. Human beings want to travel, they want to interact, they want to be aware of everything that is going on around them. In your class, you use multiple facilities such as board, marker, projector, chairs, benches etc., To talk with others you need a mobile, to be aware of world you may need a TV or internet. All these are meant for the right utilization of the Body.
 - c) Thus there are three requirements related to the Body, nutrition, protection and right utilization. The needs of the body are limited in time and limited in quantity. My need for happiness is continuous.
4. Well, having said all this, let us see now what my program is and what part of my program is to do with the physical facilities? what do I need to do?
 - a) My ('I') program for Continuous Happiness is to understand and to live in harmony at all the four levels. Continuous happiness entails understanding the harmony at all

these levels and living accordingly. If I ignore any of these levels of my living, then there may be unhappiness or contradiction at that level.

b) It is clear that basic program of 'I' is to have the right understanding and feeling, of harmony at all four levels of living. Ensuring physical facilities for the body is only a small part of the program. Ensuring physical facilities consists of production, protection and right utilization.

For example: If I grow wheat it is production. I preserve it, that it is not consumed by insects or destroyed by rain or wind. This is protection. And I eat it for the nourishment of the body- this is right utilization.

c) Today, we have ignored the "I", we know only of the existence of the "Body" and we are only aiming at having more and more Physical Facilities. These facilities do not ensure good health, happiness or the right understanding in "I". Hence we should all pay urgent attention to include the program for "I".

5. I am the Seer, I am the Doer and I am the Enjoyer.

a) I am the Seer: When we are reading a book or watching a scenery, we are engaged in the activity of seeing or understanding. Now, if someone asks us, "who is understanding all this?" after all it is 'I' who understands, 'I' who believes. We refer to ourselves as 'I' and this feeling of "I-ness" with which we identify ourselves.

Every human being actually participates in a number of such activities every day. In all these activities, the body acts only as an instrument. It is the "I" that sees or understands something.

For example: Our eyes and ears act as instruments which help us to see or listen anything. They do not convey any information. It is the "I" that understands what it has seen or listened to. "Seer" also means the one who understands. It is also called '*Drasta*'.

b) I am the Doer: Once I have seen and understood something, I decide what I should/ should not do. I take the help of my body parts to accomplish the task I want to do.

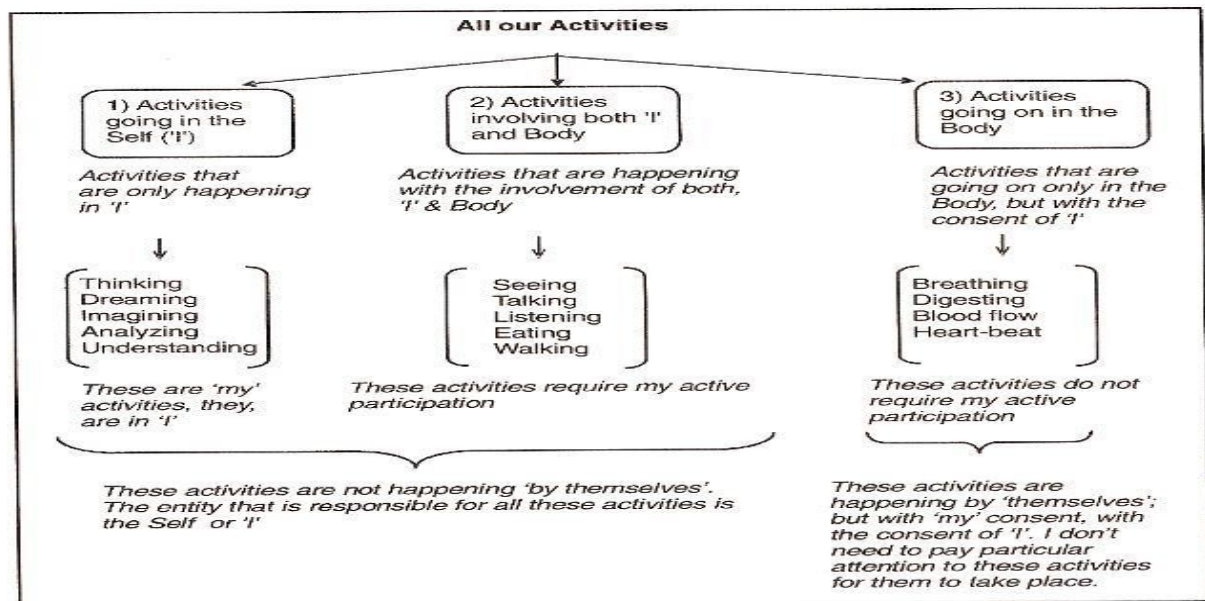
For example: I use my hands to write, my legs to walk etc. My body works as per the instructions given by me. Hence I am the Doer and I express my actions via my body. Doer means "one who does" or "the one who takes decisions to do something". It is also called '*Karta*'.

c) I am the Enjoyer: I use my body as an instrument to perform various activities. It is I who enjoy the pleasure derived out of those activities.

For example: When I eat, I am the one that gets the taste from the tongue and mouth helps to chew, but I who enjoys the taste and flavor. I am the one feeling excited, angry, sad, happy etc. my body is only one instrument. Enjoyer means "one who enjoys". It is also called '*Bhokta*'.

6. Understanding the characteristics and activities of 'I' and harmony in 'I'

a. Activities that are going on in the self ('I'):



All of us think. This is something each one of us can verify. We also imagine and this is very evident from the following example: you are sitting in the classroom and a lecture is going on. As you listen, you hear something and suddenly reminded of a thing that took place years ago. Your attention is drawn to that incident, start thinking about it and spend few minutes. After sometime, your attention shifts back into the classroom. final conclude is that your body is presence but you were not mentally. This type of incidents may occur to each and everyone. What is happening in these example? We are fully engaged in activities in ourselves, in 'I'. We are so lost in the thinking that we don't hear the inputs from the body.

If you now start observing yourself, you will see that most of the time, you are engrossed in yourself; quite oblivious to what is happening outside. This also usually happens when we are driving or riding a bike for 30 minutes through heavy traffic we may lost some attention and went to some imagination most of the time- with the result that when we reached our destination, we are surprised that we are already there! These are the activities that took place in 'I'. **Thinking, dreaming, imagining, analyzing, understanding, choosing - are the activities that took place in the Self ('I').**

These activities are going on in us all the time and we are usually unaware of them. If we start paying attention to them, we can become aware of them. We can also see that these activities take place irrespective of the state of the body. This is also something you can verify yourself- even when you are sick, the activity of thinking does not stop. If you are sick or at home you will see that you think a lot more because there is nothing much to do! This tells us that these **activities are going on the Self ('I') and are not dependent on the state of the Body.**

b. Activities involving both the self ('I') and the Body:

In the many activities we perform on a daily basis, we will discover a distinction between the Self and the Body. We saw some activities that only take place in 'I'. There are some activities that we do, in which both 'I' and body are involved.

Take the example of eating, here, I first decide which food to eat, then make the choice to take the food inside the body. I use my hands, mouth. Thus, eating is an activity which involves both the Self ('I'), where the choice is being made and the Body, with which the activity is carried out. Now, who enjoys the food? The answer is 'I' (myself). It is 'I' that gets the taste of the food and enjoys the food.

Similarly, in walking, running, studying, etc., both 'I' and the Body are involved. The decisions and choices are made in 'I' and these are carried out by the Body.

Another example **Listening**: When I listen, what is involved, I or Body or both? Suppose your father asks you to get him a glass of water, but you are busy solving your maths problem. What happens then? The words fall on your ears but you are unable to 'listen'. The Body has received the words, but you (I) have not attended to it. So, you don't respond. Thus, the participation of the body in this activity is to receive the words and your participation is to receive information from the body and gets the meaning of those words. Thus, listening involves both 'I' and Body. Few other activities like **seeing, walking, smelling, listening that requires both I and Body**.

c. Activities that are going on the Body:

The body is a set of 'self-organized activities' that are occurring with my (I) consent but without my (I) active participation. These are functions like breathing, various organ functions, digestion etc., and we will call this category of functions as 'bodily functions' or simply the activity of the 'Body'. I can choose to stop breathing when I want to but do not have to pay any special attention to keep breathing. Each one of us can easily verify this- all we have to do is start paying attention to it! Few other activities like **digestion, blood flow, heartbeat, nourishment**, etc., that are going on the body.

Knowing, assuming, recognizing and fulfilling in 'I' and recognizing and fulfilling in body:

1. **Activities of recognizing and fulfilling in the body:** We saw that Breathing, Heartbeat, Digestion etc. were activities in the body. The activities of the body can also be understood as recognition and fulfillment. In fact, the mutual interaction between any two material entities can be understood as recognition and fulfillment of their relationship. Any two material entities thus interact with each other in a definite way.
2. **Activities of knowing, assuming, recognizing and fulfilling in the self ('I'):** When it comes to self (jivan or 'I'), which is a sentient entity; a conscious entity; we will see that in addition to 'recognizing and fulfilling', there is also the activity of assuming and that of knowing. In fact, recognizing and fulfilling in case of human beings will depend upon knowing and/or assuming. Let us write down about the activities in 'I':

- a. **We assume** – We all make assumptions. We say “I assumed this was true, but I was wrong”. Ex. If I see a snake and assumed it to be a rope, I shall respond differently to it (recognition and fulfillment), than if I take it to be a snake itself. We call this activity ‘**assuming**’.
- b. **We recognize** – We all recognize things today, we recognize a variety of things. Like, we recognize water, our parents, friends, etc. We call this activity ‘recognizing’. The **recognizing** in ‘I’ depends on assuming.
- c. **We fulfill** – Once we recognize water, we take it, when we recognize a friend, we greet him/her, when we see a wounded dog, we try and help it. This response that follows recognition is called the activity of ‘**fulfilling**’. The fulfillment depends on the recognition.

Taken together we can write it as (in I) :

Assuming → recognizing → fulfilling

There is another activity that exists in us (in ‘I’) that we are largely unaware of or have not explored properly. This activity is called ‘knowing’. Knowing means we have the right understanding – the understanding of harmony at all levels of our living. When we have the right understanding, when we have the knowledge of reality, it is definite, and then assuming becomes according to the knowing and hence recognizing and fulfilling becomes definite or according to knowing. Until then, it is subject to beliefs and assumptions and this keeps changing.

When we list these down:

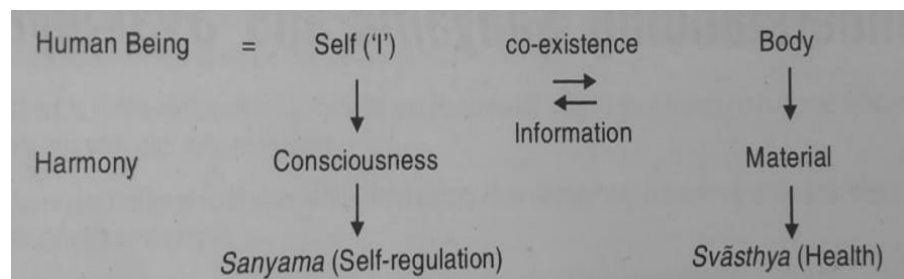
Knowing → leads to Assuming → leads to Recognizing → leads to Fulfilling

7. Understanding the harmony of Self (I) with the Body- -Sanyama and Health

The human body is a self organized and highly sophisticated mechanism. We observe that the body is made up of several organs and glands in the different parts of the body keep working in a close coordination. The body is made-up of cells and each cell of the body performing so many functions ever moment. Close observation of the body reveals that each cell is self organized and participating in the self-organization of the body as whole.

All this activity keeps the body fit for the use of "I" so that "I" and the Body may work in synergy as human being. Let us understand the salient aspects of harmony between "I" and the Body.

The harmony of "I" with the body is in the form of Sanyama on the part of "I" and health on the part of the Body.



1. *Sanyama* (SELF-REGULATION): The feeling of responsibility in the self ("I") for nurturing, protection and right utilization of the body.

As a come to realize that the body is my instrument and that the body needs nutrition, protection and utilized to work as an efficient and effective tool for the right purpose, "I" become responsible to the body. This sense of responsible flows naturally and does not have to be imposed. Thus the feeling of responsibility that is regulating the way we take care of and use our body.

When I live with *Sanyama*, there is a harmony among the different parts of the body and the body acts according to me as useful instrument. Thus, we define health as having two elements:

1. The body acts according to the needs of "I"
2. There is harmony among the parts of the Body

So, health is the condition of the body where every part of the body is performing its expected function. There is a harmony within the body and it is fit for use by the self. In fact, the world health literally means being anchored to the self, being in close harmony with the self.

Now, one more thing can be observed. If there is *Sanyama*, health can be ensured and if *Sanyama* is not there, a good health also be lost. So, *Sanyama* is vital for the health and needs to be given due priority. We plan to earn and save a lot of money so that we get well treated in a good quality hospital when we are sick. But are we equally serious in ensuring *Sanyama*? we will discuss in detail here.

Our State Today

What is our state today? Today we are facing different problems and they are lack of responsibility towards the body, tendency for medication to suppress the ailment and polluted air, water, food. Let's take them in detail:

- A. Lack of responsibility towards the Body:** Our lifestyle has become very busy and unnatural. We usually do not give priority to take proper care of the body. We have increasingly started eating at odd hours, eating junk food, and are largely ignorant about the state of our body. We tend to look with contempt (disrespectful) on any kind of physical work or labor. For example: In an attempt to keep enjoying tasty food, we ignore the fact that we are eating for the nourishment of the body and not to perpetuate (continue, maintain) the happiness of 'I'.
- B. Tendency for Medication to suppress the Ailment:** Whenever there is a pain in any part of the body, it is a signal of some disorder which needs to be properly attended to. However, our common tendency has become to suppress this pain by immediate medication and then forget about it. Our focus today seems to be more on 'fighting germs in the body' than on helping the body restore itself to its natural state of harmony.

In fact, today we are focusing a lot more on what to do if we fall ill rather than learning to live healthy. It thus becomes important for each one of us to become

aware of our own body and its needs and how common, simple medication can be used to facilitate the body to come back to health in care of ailments (slight illness).

C. Polluted Air, Water, Food: We have polluted our environment today and it is directly or indirectly harming us. There is contamination in the air, water, soil, plants and we are responsible for it. Our food has become impure. Due to heavy use of chemical fertilizers, pesticides and a lot of pollutions, our food has all kinds of toxic contents in it. The air we breathe in, is polluted by various chemicals released from industries and vehicles, while our water is also polluted due to industrial effluents (liquid sewage), sewage etc., All this, surely, is not conducive to the health of people.

2. HEALTH (Swasthya): The word Swasthya literally means being anchored to the self, being in close harmony with the self. In other words, Swasthya, in Sanskrit means self-dependence (Swa = your own).

Health is the general condition of a person. World Health Organization (WHO) in 1948, health was defined as being ‘**a state of complete physical, mental, and social well-being and not merely the absence of diseases or infirmity**’.

Aspects of Health:

Health is a holistic term which includes:

- ⇒ Physical health
- ⇒ Mental health
- ⇒ Social health

The Health Triangle

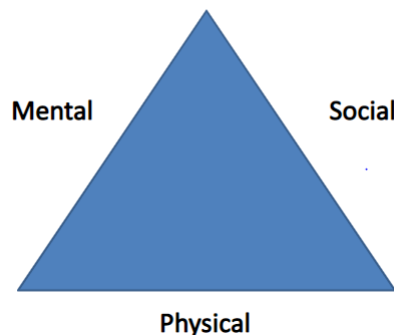


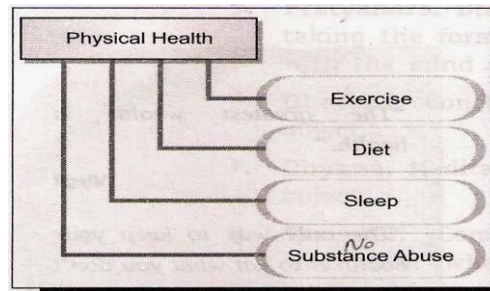
Fig: The Inputs of Holistic Health

a) Physical Health: For humans, physical health means a good body health, which is healthy because of regular physical activity (exercise), good nutrition and adequate rest.

Physical health relates to anything concerning our body as physical entities. In other terms, **physical health is physical wellbeing**. Physical wellbeing is defined as something a person can achieve by developing all health-related components of his/her life style. Fitness reflects a person's cardio-respiratory endurance, muscular strength, flexibility and body composition. Other contributors of physical wellbeing may include proper nutrition, body weight management, abstaining from drug abuse, avoiding alcohol

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abuse, hygiene and getting the right amount of sleep.

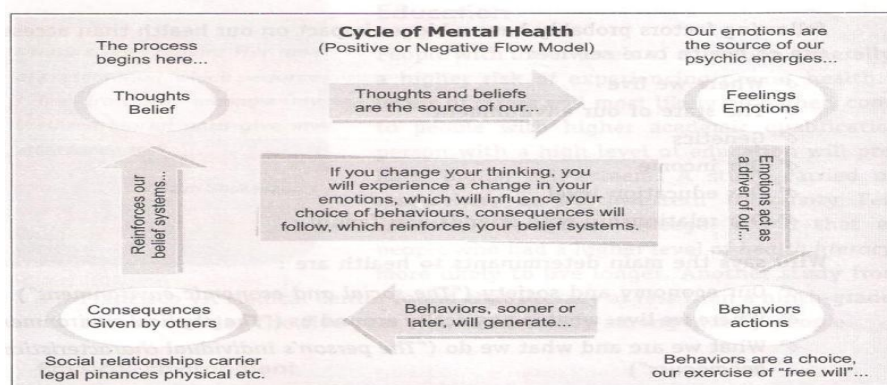


Building Physical Health

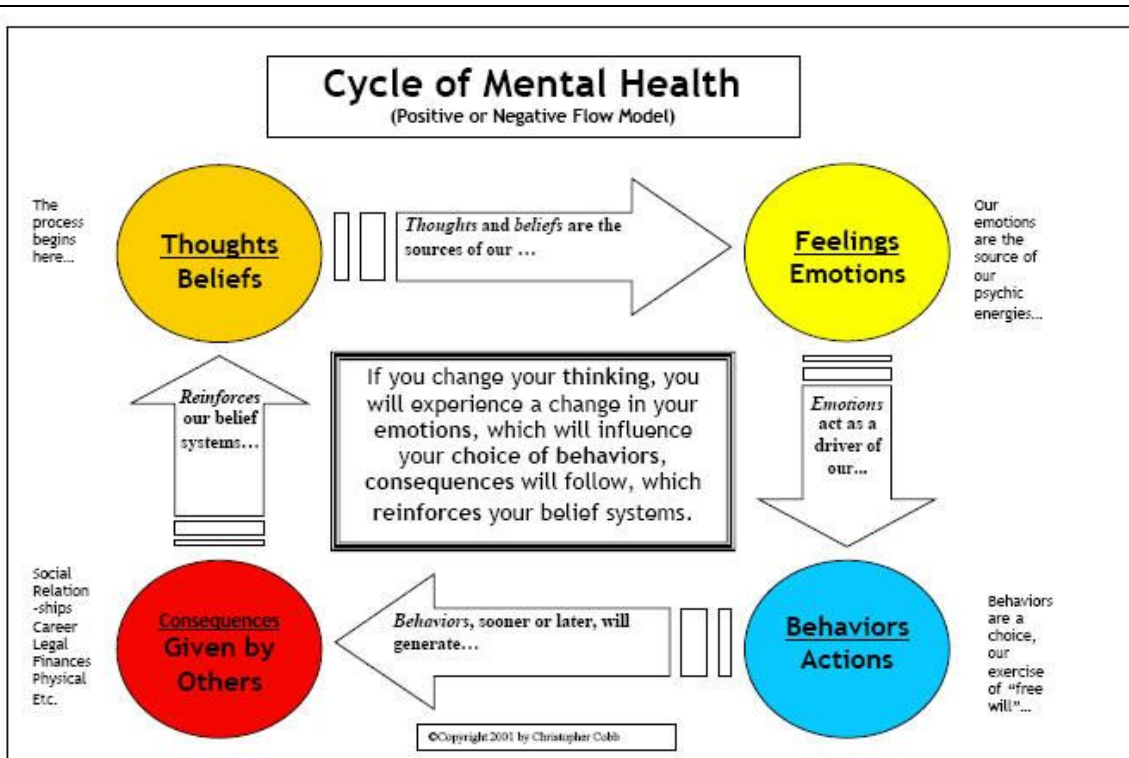
1. Eat a healthy, well balanced diet.
2. Take care of personal hygiene and cleanliness (brushes your teeth regularly, bath daily, wear clean clothes etc.
3. Keep your surrounding clean
4. Drink clean and safe water
5. Breathe deeply. Take deep slow breaths. Your body needs the oxygen
6. Go for a walk regularly
7. Exercise daily, play a game, go to the gym, jog or walk briskly
8. Avoid fizzy drink, chips and junk food as far as possible
9. Eat in moderate quantity – less is better than excess. But make sure what you eat is nutritious
10. Keep your nails clipped and clean

b) Mental Health: Mental health refers to people's cognitive and emotional wellbeing. A person who enjoys good mental health does not have a mental disorder.

In other words **sound mental health is that state of the mind which can maintain a calm positive poise, or regain it when unsettled for progressively longer durations or quickly, in the midst of all the external vagaries of work life and social existence.**



Most people agree that mental health includes the ability to enjoy life, the ability to bounce back from adversity, the ability to achieve balance (moderation) the ability to be flexible and adapt, the ability to feel safe and secure, and self-actualization (making the best of what you have).



Restoring Mental Health

Here are a few vital guidelines whose practice could restore our personal command over mental health:

1. Cultivate a sound philosophy of life, based on values.
2. Identify with an inner core of self-sufficiency through "simple living and high thinking"
3. Nourish a sense of equilibrium strive for excellence through 'work is worship' – take pride in your work
4. Build a stable and exalted inner reference point for the integration of contrary impulses, emotions, etc.
5. Cultivate the value of purity
6. Practice self-discipline through deep breathing
7. Develop the habit of radiating goodwill and harmony from the centre of one's being- be positive, to attract good things

c) Social Health

Social health refers to the ability of a person to fit in with the social setup and maintain positive and harmonious inter-personal relations. Social health contributes towards physical and mental health which is why it must be given due importance.

Enhance Social Health: To enhance social health, a human being must:

1. Learn to be tolerant
2. Learn to appreciate diversity and realize that people can be different from us and yet be very capable in their own way
3. Practice good manners – always be polite and pleasant
4. Conduct one-self with grace and dignity

5. Be helpful, loyal and trustworthy. Develop the qualities of a good friend
6. Don't be self-centered.

Determinants of health:

The health of individual people and their communities are affected by a wide range of contributing factors. People's good or bad health is determined by their environment and situation– what is happening and what has happened to them, say *WHO*. *WHO* says that the following factors probably have a bigger impact on our health than access and use of health care services.

- ⇒ Where we live
- ⇒ The state of our environment
- ⇒ Genetics
- ⇒ Our income
- ⇒ Our educational level
- ⇒ Our relationship with friends and family

As our good health depends on the context of our lives, praising or criticizing people for their good or bad health is wrong. Most of the factors that contribute towards our good or bad health are out of our control.

***** **End of Unit-II** *****